

OREGON CITY COURIER

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IN BEHALF OF THE FARMER

Probably because of the well-founded American notion that the farmer is the backbone and a considerable part of the brain of the universe he is asked to bear the burden and the brunt of most anything that the dear people wish to pile onto him. This holds true especially in connection with the high cost of living. Generally the public has forgotten the notorious middleman, whose depredations in other days caused him to suffer everything from heated curses to having his evil form burned at the stake. Yet, we can find no good reason for not belaboring the middleman just as much as anyone, and perhaps a little bit more, for the unprecedented height to which life's necessities have soared.

After all, the poor farmer plays only a minor role in the constantly advancing cost of living. We malign the farmer because eggs are put beyond our morning menu by reason of their excessive cost. We haven't stopped to recall that the farmer doesn't get the bigger part of the egg profit, and we forget that the hens are demanding in their loud cackling style the best of wheat at the highest of prices.

We are anxious to blight the farmer's hope of heaven because we pay too much for potatoes, forgetting such small incidents as the increased cost of production and the unheard-of profits that are made upon potatoes after they leave the farmer's keeping and get into the hands of criminal food speculators and middlemen.

As a matter of fact, farm products have advanced in cost. Why shouldn't they advance? The farmer who sold his wheat for \$1 a hundred bought it back from his grocer as flour and paid \$10 a hundred. Does it cost the miller \$9 to produce 100 pounds of flour; or does it cost him even \$5?

The merry motorist who disports himself about the countryside tearing up the roads that are built with the hard-earned money of the tiller of the soil has not yet blamed the farmer for the high price of gasoline, but it is a matter of wonder that he has not.

There is talk constantly of boycotting potatoes and eggs and other farm products. We have yet to hear some noble gentleman advance the idea of boycotting gasoline. The last pair of shoes we bought cost \$9.50. A year or so ago we bought the same shoes for \$5. We hadn't yet thought of boycotting the shoe manufacturer, in spite of the fact that there is evidence that he has made an exorbitant profit from his wares. And in the meantime the boycott on farm products goes merrily on.

It seems that the dear public would willingly go eggless at the breakfast hour, and potatoless at dinner and even milkless at the noonday lunch, but there is little possibility that there will be any notable number traveling our rain-drenched highways without shoes, or even refusing to buy the miller's flour because it costs \$10 a sack; and the motorist has yet to volunteer a boycott.

Verily, the farmer bears the burden and the brunt, as far as the Courier has been able to determine, for most of the sins that visit the world, and he still remains the backbone and a considerable part of the brain of the universe. It is hardly a square deal for such an important element in the world's physical and mental composition.

AN OBJECT LESSON

The agricultural situation that has arisen as a result of three years of world war calls attention vividly to the price western Oregon is paying for its failure to realize the benefits sure to come from draining its low lands. Within the last two years the whole existing body of theory as to agricultural production has been overturned. The fear of over-production has been temporarily banished, and the markets of the world are

clamoring for every pound of food that can be produced. This means that the owners of low and poorly drained lands are losing huge sums because they did not realize soon enough the importance of drainage, says the Eugene Register.

In the neighborhood of Eugene alone there are more than 50,000 acres of land that sadly needs drainage, and if this vast area could be planted this year to the food crops for which there is a strong demand the effect on general business conditions would be marked. The owners would be able to more than repay the entire cost in a single season, and the money that would be brought in for the added crops would go far toward lifting the depression that has prevailed for several years.

But this is no time for weeping over spilled milk and doing nothing to take care of the future. Even if the war should end this week, the demand for foodstuffs will continue brisk for a long time—probably for several years. The world has been drained of its food supplies, and it will take more than one ample harvest to fill up the void that has been created. The opportunity is by no means past to make drainage pay for itself in a short time.

The past two years have taught the Willamette valley a lesson that must be heeded. We have learned that inability to sell our products has been due not so much to over-production as to our failure to find the markets that already exist. We have depended too much on purely local demand instead of getting out and finding where our surplus production can be sold. Strange to say, we have learned that our trouble lies not in over-production, but in under-production. We have not been producing our specially favored crops in large enough quantities to attract the attention of large buyers.

The present high prices ought to be an object lesson for western Oregon. The low lands ought to be drained.

BEAN AND PEA WEEVILS

Trouble Can be Corrected, Says Agricultural College Expert

In response to an inquiry sent to the Oregon Agricultural college from this county, where bean and pea weevils have been giving farmers and small planters considerable trouble within the past few years, the college has sent out the following information regarding the control of the pest.

Stored beans and peas possibly suffer more from insect attack than do the crops in the field. Two weevils are particularly bad in Oregon and will be given brief consideration. The bean weevil attacks the pods in the field and is also able to breed in the stored seed. The first evidence of infestation is usually in the stored seed. Many beans will show the round hole where the adult weevil has emerged, and an examination of the interior of others will disclose the grubs still at work inside. Several grubs may feed on the interior of a single bean.

The adult bean weevil is one-eighth inch in length. It is covered with a coat of brown-grey and olive pubescence, giving the body a mottled effect. The wing covers are shorter than the body. The hind femur has one large spine and two small ones.

The adult weevil deposits eggs in or on the pods in the field. The grubs hatch and burrow into the beans to feed and develop. Where infested seed is planted, the grubs will continue development, and proceed to infest the new crop.

Control measures. Weevily beans should not be planted. The vitality of an injured seed is low and many will not germinate.

A temperature of 145 degrees Fahrenheit will kill the weevil in all its stages and will not injure the germination of the seed. To treat the seed with heat, place seed in a suitable receptacle in an oven and raise to required temperature; hold here for 6 hours.

United States Submarine G-1

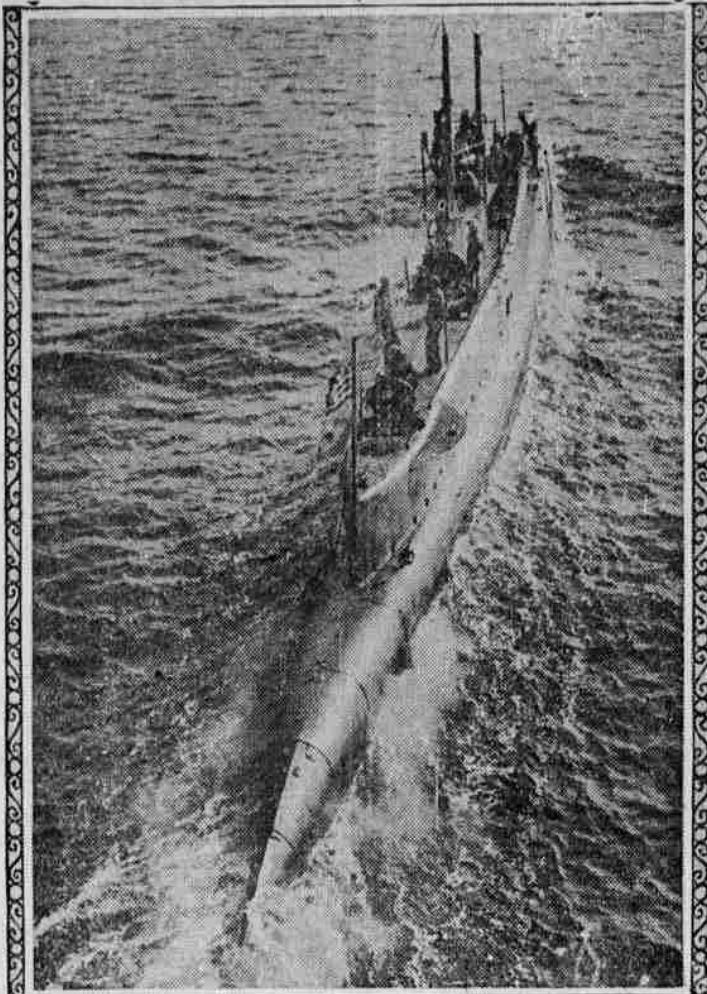


Photo by American Press Association.
The submarine G-1 is a 525 ton submersible and carries six torpedo tubes. She is 160 feet in length and at her best can make over fourteen knots an hour.

Fumigation with carbon-bisulfide is the standard treatment for stored grain pests. Beans placed in a tight receptacle of some sort may be treated very effectively.

If infected seed is to be planted it should be poured into boiling water at planting time to kill the grubs. Cool at once by the addition of cold water.

Carbon-bisulfide, suggested above, is a liquid which on exposure to air passes off as gas. This gas has a pungent, disagreeable odor and is heavier than air. The dosage is from 5 to 8 pounds to 100 bushels of seed, or 1 pound to 100 cubic feet of space. The seed should be placed in an airtight tin or box, or the receptacle made as nearly gas proof as possible. The liquid may be poured over the surface of the seed, or better still, placed in trays or dishes on top of the seed. Close the bin securely and leave for 24 hours. Open at the end of this period and ventilate thoroughly.

Caution. Carbon bisulfide is very inflammable. It should never be opened near a fire, and one should dispense with smoking while applying it.

The pea weevil. The evidences of injury due to the pea weevil are practically the same as that of the bean weevil. The beetle is larger and does not breed in the stored seed. Nevertheless, in the northwest this pest is the more serious of the two, and the losses due to it are much heavier. Dr. Fletcher estimates that the loss in Ontario alone is now over \$1,000,000 annually.

The adult weevils appear in the field at blossoming time and deposit eggs on the forming pods. Thus the peas of an eating size are often grubby. The grubs are mature at gathering time. They pupate in the stored pea and later emerge as adult beetles. Ordinarily, only one weevil occurs in a pea, and, as stated before, there is a single generation during the year, the insect being unable to breed in the stored seed.

Control measures. Care should be taken to distinguish between this pest and the previous one, as the variation in habits makes a difference in the control measures adopted. Hold-over seed. If the seed is held over a season in a tight bin or receptacle, the weevil will emerge and die, as it cannot breed in dried seed.

Peas should be securely bagged immediately after threshing. Kerosene at the rate of one-half gallon to 5 bushels of seed is recommended. Simply pour the liquid over the peas, stir thoroughly, then spread the peas out so the oil may pass off.

The treatments as recommended for the bean weevil are equally efficacious for this pest, fumigation being the standard treatment for the stored seed.

REQUIRE PAR BID

Money for Farm Loans Comes From State Coeffers

If bids for the next issue of \$500,000 of rural credits bonds of the state of Oregon are not for par or better they will not be accepted, and it will be the policy of the present land board at no time to discount.

No formal statement has been issued by the members of the land board to this effect, but it is known from the attitude of the individual members that if no bids for par or better are received the state will continue to use state money to take over the bonds, and if the state money becomes exhausted no further loans will be made until such time as the bonds do sell at par or better.

It is believed by members of the board, however, that the issue to be sold May 22 will receive much better bids than the preceding issue. One large eastern insurance company has sent a representative to make a personal inquiry as to the bonds, and it is understood that company considers bonds of this nature excellent securities for its surplus.

The first issue of \$250,000 is being taken care of from the industrial accident fund, and a similar disposition will be made of the next issue, if no better bids are received on it than on the preceding issue.

The Courier and the Daily Journal \$4.75.

THE KID ENLISTS

The Kid has gone to the Colors
And we don't know what to say;
The Kid we have loved and cuddled
Stepped out for the Flag today.
We thought him a child, a baby,
With never a care at all,
But his country called him man-size
And the Kid has heard the call.

He paused to watch the recruiting,
When, fired by life and drum,
He bowed his head to Old Glory
And thought that it whispered:
"Come!"

The Kid, not being a slacker,
Stood forth with patriot-joy
To add his name to the roster,
And God, we're proud of the boy!

The Kid has gone to the Colors
It seems but a little while
Since he drilled a school boy army
In a truly martial style.
But now he's a man, a soldier,
And we lend him listening ear,
For his heart is a heart all loyal,
Uncouraged by the curse of fear.

His dad, when he told him, shuddered,
His mother—God bless her—cried;
Yet, blest with a mother nature,
She wept with a mother pride.
But he whose old shoulders straightened
Was Granddad—for memory ran
To years when he, too, a youngster,
Was changed by the Flag to a man.

—W. M. Herschel,
in Indianapolis News.

THE TAXPAYER PAYS NOTHING, MR. FARMER

To the editor:

So much has already been said for the bond bill for \$8,000,000 for permanent roads that it seems unnecessary to say more, but with two such men as the master of the state grange and the president of the Farmers' union fighting the issue and calling it a carpeting plan for silk stockings tourists and other auto owners, and telling the farmer that the proposed roads are for scenic purposes and not market roads, it falls upon someone to refute these statements, which I feel both gentlemen know they are making, even though some are more lenient and say they don't know any better.

In the first place all the roads to be hard surfaced lead to and from the markets of the various counties out into the farming districts. True, they do not lead into all the farming districts of each county.

In the second place, all the roads are farmer roads, market roads, as well as trunk highways for scenic, business, military or any other purpose, leading from the California line south to the Washington line north and to the Idaho line east.

In the third place the auto owners through the increased auto license will pay not only the bonds but interest as well and no money from general taxation will be required.

In the fourth place, each of the counties through which the permanent highway is scheduled to pass, will save thousands of dollars each year now spent on maintenance of the present roads in order to keep them in passable condition at least a part of each year, which money will either be saved to the taxpayer, or else apportioned by the county commissioners to other market roads of the various counties.

The fact that Clackamas county will get 20 miles of permanent road without any cost to the taxpayer after the grade is prepared, at least 75 per cent of which is already to grade, should be sufficient to cause every taxpayer to vote for the bond issue.

The fact that the taxpayer will save the present cost of repair of this same trunk highway, better than \$15,000 per year in the case of Clackamas county, after the permanent roads are constructed all expense of upkeep, if any, to fall upon the state, and not the county, even in part, should cause each taxpayer to get out and boost for the bond issue that all voters not taxpayers will be sure to vote for the \$8,000,000 bonds.

The fact that automobiles wear out the roads, and particularly the trunk roads, over which 90 per cent of the traffic goes, and that the own-

ers of the motor cars will pay the bill in full, not only in part, should be welcome news to every taxpayer, for it will be the first time that anyone will do anything toward repairing the damage done to our roads.

The fact that the auto owner is willing to pay the bill, even though the rural taxpayer may not think that the auto owner should pay all, should be sufficient to cause the taxpayer to grant this privilege to the auto owner, as it certainly will be a privilege considering the great annual saving to the motor car owner.

But, to sum the entire matter up in a few words, the fact that it is good business: that there will be such a great saving and at no expense to the taxpayer is the reason why so many are already in favor of the bond act and why all the others should and will be for it when they are presented with the truth in regard to the matter.

At one time, as Barnum stated, "the American people like to be humbugged" was a fact, but they are too intelligent at this enlightened day to allow anyone to fill them with misleading statements, which can be and will be found out as anything but the truth.

The taxpayer cannot make a mistake by voting for the bonds and if you, Mr. Farmer living off the proposed permanent roads who might not be an auto owner, and who might not be favorable to having autos wear out your roads which have cost you so dearly, vote for the bonds and build the roads in question, when you can depend upon it that the greater per cent of the traffic will follow the hard surfaced all-the-year road, thus taking it away from your districts to a great extent.

But there are hundreds of farmers owning automobiles and before all the hard surfaced roads outlined are completed, there will be thousands of owners of motor cars residing in the rural districts.

Vote for road bonds, and save your county money, that it may be available for use in your own road district.

B. T. McBAIN,
for 12 Disciples of Road Efficiency.

FARM LABOR IN DEMAND

Increased Wages Fail to Secure Sufficient Help

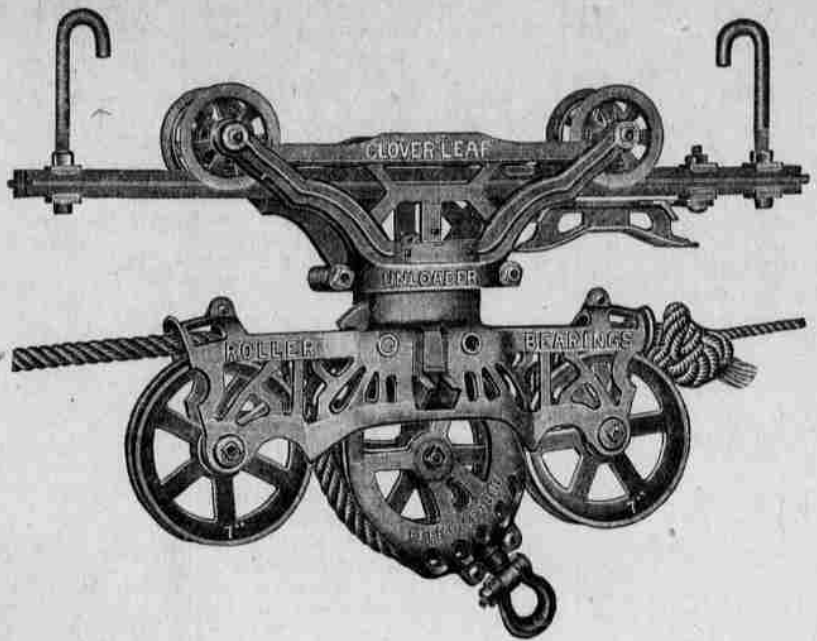
If Oregon's crops are to be grown and harvested for a record in the economic race, thousands of volunteers are at once needed for farm labor.

Despite the fact that wages this year are considerably higher than heretofore, the increase ranging from 25 to 50 per cent, the dearth of farm

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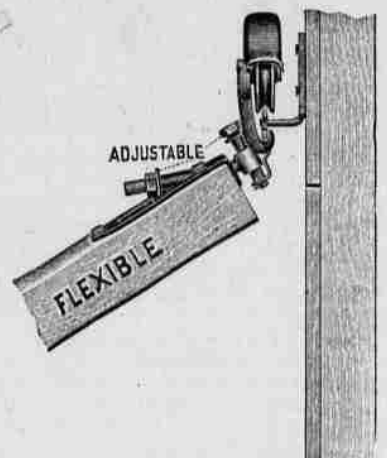
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help presists, say employment agencies. "There is a tremendous shortage of farm labor," was the statement made in Portland last week. "We are not in any sense able to supply the demand for experienced help."

During the month of March the public employment bureau of Portland sent out 500 farm laborers to jobs in various parts of Oregon. The average so far the present month has been 30 to 40 men a day. Yet of these who are employed, it is stated, many are men who have recently quit other farm employment, and the echo of their departure in time reaches the employment office.

Other employment offices confirm this report as applying to their own daily experiences. All are supplying a few men daily, with hundreds of requests for help already on file and awaiting supply.

The demand is heaviest from central Oregon, it is said, though there is a strong call from the Willamette valley and every part of the state.

Good Roads Pointers

A vote for the road bond bill will be a vote for a state-wide system of good roads without increasing direct taxes. Don't forget this when you vote June 4.

No property-owner should complain about the road bond measure. It is simply a proposition by which the state proposes to build a system of permanent highways from revenue already provided and without any increase in the direct tax levy.

Young men are being continually urged to "get back to the farm," but they are expected to wade in mud up to their knees to get there. Vote for the \$8,000,000 bond measure and help make the farm more accessible to labor as well as to the markets.

From a series of investigations the U. S. department of agriculture has found that, following the improvement of the main market roads, the increase in the selling price of tillable farm lands served by the roads has amounted to from one to three times the total cost of the improvements.

Owners of automobiles will be required to pay the increased license fee whether the road bond bill passes or not. On the other hand if the road bonds are voted at the June election, a real start will be assured in giving to the state a system of permanent highways constructed from automobile license fees and without increasing the general tax.

The construction of hard-surfaced roads that will enable the farmer to reach the Columbia river with his grain and other products will give the producers of eastern Oregon the full benefit of water competition in marketing their products and will ultimately bring about a reduction of excessive freight rates that are now in effect over the various branch railroad lines on which the farmer is now dependent for transportation.

The annual license on all automobiles has been doubled. The fees from this source will be adequate to

pay the interest and the principal of the \$6,000,000 road bonds. Automobile owners are willing to pay the increased license but ask that the money raised therefrom shall be spent in road construction. Why not? They are going to pay the bill. And it will not be necessary to raise general taxes, either. Vote for the bonds.

The fact that the United States is at war with a foreign foe only furnishes an additional argument in support of the good roads bond bill. Improved and serviceable highways are a military necessity in time of war. In their present condition, even the main trunk roads in this state are entirely inadequate to meet the situation should the Pacific coast ever be attacked by unfriendly forces. Good roads are not only desirable in time of peace but are positively indispensable when the country is in a state of war.

Commenting on the selection of Herbert Nunn as state highway engineer, R. B. Murdock, roadmaster for Coos county, pays the following high tribute to the qualifications of Mr. Nunn: "By executive and technical training and experience, he is easily the best qualified man in the state of Oregon, if not on the Pacific coast, for the position which he has recently been appointed to fill. The commission is to be complimented upon their choice and the state upon its good fortune in securing Mr. Nunn's services."

Hokanson Wants Papers. Ernest Hokanson, a native of Sweden, Saturday applied for final certificate of citizenship. Hokanson is a carpenter and lives at Oak Grove. He is 37 years old and came to the United States from Canada in 1900.

Keeping Yourself Well

THE FIRST STEP

Usually the first indication of a lowering of health is found in the bowels and liver. Something goes wrong—we eat too much, or work too hard—and the bowel action weakens or the liver is sluggish. That heavy feeling on arising in the morning, dryness of the throat, with bad taste, a slight headache, dull eyes—all show that food has fermented in the intestines, and that the body is manufacturing poisons instead of good blood.

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